

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

1994-01-04

To all National Spiritual Assemblies

1 dear bahá'í friends,

As construction work commences on the first of the monumental edi-

fices which must be raised on mount carmel to complete the world Ad-

2 ministrative center of the bahá'í faith, it seems appropriate to review the

3 significance of this vast project and to reflect on its basic purpose.

4 The projects under way on this mountain are of profound significance.

5 They represent much more than the erection of buildings to meet the ex-panding needs of the bahá'í world center. The call for contributions to

6 the Arc projects fund, far from being a diversion of resources which might

7 otherwise be used to help relieve the distress of mankind, offers the follow-ers of bahá'u'lláh a providential opportunity to participate in an endeavor

8 which is central to the work of the faith in eradicating the causes of the

9 appalling suffering now afflicting humanity.

The bahá'í community encourages and supports the manifold efforts be-

10 ing made by people of goodwill to better the condition of humankind and promote unity and harmony among the peoples and nations of the earth.

11 however, the believers should never, for even one moment, lose sight of

12 the fact that the crisis now engulfing every part of the planet is essentially

13 spiritual. "That which the lord hath ordained as the sovereign remedy and

14 mightiest instrument for the healing of all the world," bahá'u'lláh em-

15 phatically states, "is the union of all its peoples in one universal cause, one

common faith."

16 176-1 our acute awareness of the magnitude of the misery

17 which so many groups and individuals are experiencing should spur us on to

18 ever-greater exertions, inspired and animated by an abiding consciousness

19 that only through the world order of bahá'u'lláh can the multitudinous
 20 problems burdening humanity be resolved.
 21 176-1. gwb, no. 120.3.176.1
 176 2
 176 3
 177 m e S a g e S f r o m T h e u n i v e r S a l h o u S e o f j u S T i c e
 178 70from the dawn of bahá'í history, attention has been directed to the glory
 179 of the world order which the revelation of bahá'u'lláh is destined to un-
 180 fold. The báb himself declared, “ well is it with him who fixeth his gaze
 181 upon the order of bahá'u'lláh and rendereth thanks unto his lord!” while
 182 bahá'u'lláh affirmed, in the mother book of his dispensation, that “the
 183 world’s equilibrium hath been upset through the vibrating influence of this
 184 most great, this new world order.”176-2 it is abundantly evident that the ex-
 185 alted aims of the faith can be accomplished only through the instrumental-
 186 ity of the world order which bahá'u'lláh has established for that purpose.
 187 The spiritual transformation of humanity, the relief of the diverse peoples
 188 of the earth from rampant suffering, the attainment and preservation of true peace in
 the world, the birth of a world civilization—all such noble
 189 objectives of the cause of god will remain unrealized unless they are as-
 190 sociated with that radical change in the structure and functioning of human
 191 society inherent in the growth and fruition of his divinely ordained order.
 192 The institutions of the bahá'í Administrative order, now being raised in all
 193 parts of the world through the endeavors of the believers, are the precursor, the
 nucleus and the pattern of that world order which will, in the course
 194 of time, exert its full benevolent influence on all the peoples of the earth.
 195 Shoghi effendi explained that the revelation by bahá'u'lláh of the kitáb-
 196 i-Aqdas “preserves for posterity the basic laws and ordinances on which the fabric of
 his future world order must rest.” And he referred to “the
 197 triple impulse generated through the revelation of the Tablet of carmel by
 198 bahá'u'lláh and the will and Testament as well as the Tablets of the divine
 199 plan bequeathed by the center of his covenant—the three charters which
 200 have set in motion three distinct processes, the first operating in the holy

201 land for the development of the institutions of the faith at its world cen-
202 ter and the other two, throughout the rest of the bahá'í world, for its propa-
gation and the establishment of its Administrative order."

203 176-3 These three
204 processes, although distinct, are closely interrelated. developments at the
205 world center of the faith, the heart and nerve-center of the Administrative
206 order, must necessarily exert a pronounced influence on the organic body
207 of the worldwide bahá'í community, and be affected by its vitality. The
208 Administrative order may best be viewed as the chief instrument for the
209 176-2. wob, p. 147; kA, ¶181.

210 176-3. gpb, p. 213; mbw , p. 84.176.4

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178 71prosecution of the divine plan, while that plan has become recognized as
179 the most potent agency for the development of the administrative structure
180 of the faith. it follows that, for the sound and balanced growth of the faith
181 and the speedy attainment of world order, due attention must be paid to all
182 three processes.

The construction work now in progress on mount carmel should be

183 seen as a major historic thrust in the development of the first of these three mighty
processes—a process which was launched more than one hundred years ago by bahá'u'lláh
himself when he pitched his tent on this holy

184 mountain and revealed the Tablet described by the guardian as “the char-

ter of the world Spiritual and Administrative centers of the faith."

185 176-4 The

186 unfoldment of this process has been distinguished by the interment of the
187 sacred remains of the báb in the bosom of this mountain within a sanc-
188 tuary built by ‘Abdu’l-b ahá, followed subsequently by the erection of the
189 superstructure of the Shrine of the báb by Shoghi effendi. when, in 1939,
190 the guardian transferred the bodily remains of the brother and mother of
191 the master to their final resting-place in the immediate vicinity of that of

192 the greatest holy leaf, he described his action as one which “incalculably
193 reinforces the spiritual potencies of that consecrated Spot which, under the
194 wings of the báb’s overshadowing Sepulcher,” is designated to be the “focal
195 center of these world-shaking, world-embracing, world-directing adminis-trative
institutions”

196 176-5 which the followers of bahá’u’lláh are raising for the
197 salvation of humanity and the fulfillment of its glorious destiny.

198 Shortly before his passing, the guardian completed the structure of the
199 international bahá’í Archives, “the first stately edifice destined to usher
200 in the establishment of the world Administrative center of the faith on
201 mount carmel—the Ark referred to by bahá’u’lláh in the closing passages

of his Tablet of carmel.”176-6

202 in more recent years the contributions of the believers around the world
203 second of the edifices which Shoghi effendi had envisaged as being located
204 on a far-flung arc, surrounding the resting-places of the members of the holy family.
This achievement opened the way for the announcement in

205 1987 of the project for erection of the remaining buildings of the world

206 176-4. mbw , p. 63.

207 176-5. Tdh, no. 64.6.

208 176-6. mbw , p. 64.176.6

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177 m e S a g e S f r o m T h e u n i v e r S a l h o u S e o f j u S T i c e

178 72Administrative center of the faith and for the construction of the eighteen
179 monumental Terraces contemplated by ‘Abdu’l-b ahá, below and above the
180 Shrine of the báb. it signaled a major step toward the consummation of the
181 vision expressed by the guardian as “the splendor of the institutions which
182 that triumphant faith must erect on the slopes of a mountain, destined to
183 be so linked with the city of ‘Akká that a single grand metropolis will be
184 formed to enshrine the spiritual as well as the administrative seats of the

future b ahá’í commonwealth.”176-7

185 The edifices and Terraces now under construction are a manifest expres-
186 sion of the emergence from obscurity of the faith of bahá'u'lláh and of the
187 determining role it is ordained to play in the affairs of humankind. when
188 the buildings are completed, they will stand as the visible seat of mighty institutions
whose purpose is no other than the spiritualization of humanity and the preservation of
justice and unity throughout the world. The future
189 significance of the Terraces is evident from their characterization by Shoghi
190 effendi as "the pathway of the kings and rulers of the world." The beauty
191 and magnificence of the gardens and Terraces now under development are
192 symbolic of the nature of the transformation which is destined to occur
193 both within the hearts of the world's peoples and in the physical environ-
194 ment of the planet.

The establishment of the world Administrative center of the faith on

195 mount carmel at this juncture in the fortunes of mankind is essential to

hasten the accomplishment of god's purpose for humanity through the

196 operation of the world order of bahá'u'lláh. The believers are called upon
197 to sustain this vast collective enterprise upon which the community of the

most great Name is now embarked, through a sacrificial outpouring of

198 material resources and through their dedication to the work of the cause at
199 this time of unprecedented need and opportunity.

mount carmel was extolled by the prophet isaiah almost three thousand

200 years ago, when he announced that "it shall come to pass in the last days,
201 that the mountain of the lord's house shall be established in the top of
202 the mountains, and shall be exalted above the hills; and all nations shall

flow unto it."

203 176-8 Now, with the coming of the lord of hosts, his devoted

servants throughout the world have been summoned to the momentous

204 176-7 . gpb, pp. 315-6.

205 176-8. i saiah 2:2 (kjv).176.9

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178 7undertaking with which the fulfillment of this ancient promise is associated.
179 As they dedicate themselves to this mighty task, let them draw inspiration
180 from these words of bahá'u'lláh: “carmel, in the book of god, hath been
181 designated as the hill of god, and his vineyard. it is here that, by the grace
182 of the lord of revelation, the Tabernacle of glory hath been raised. happy
183 are they that attain thereunto; happy they that set their faces towards it.”176-9
184 with loving b ahá'í greetings,
185 177

Reference to the Guardianship in the Kitáb-i-Aqdas

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]